

ZAKIY T. MANIGO

AI Product Engineer

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AI product engineer who ships model-backed features with constraints: grounding, cost/latency, failure UX, and safety. Applies existing models in production products — does not claim foundation-model training.

EXPERIENCE

FITD — Founder & AI Product Engineer

2025 – Present

- Shipped AI in the product: Gemini 2.0 Flash closet/brand labeling, stylist grounded on wardrobe + weather, daily colors/styles, and Vertex virtual try-on via a Cloud Function proxy so the mobile client never embeds the key.
- Built community bots (Gemini, Imagen, Veo) with human approval, quotas, moderation, and a kill switch. Recommendation scoring from likes, onboarding, and implicit signals. Production SwiftUI app + Firebase/GCP; do not claim systematic evals or fine-tunes.

BariAccess (TREI) — Software Engineer (one of two primary engineers)

Jul 2026 – Present · New York, NY / Remote

- Productized a guarded Azure OpenAI assistant (Aba) on a GLP-1 / metabolic-care platform: voice + text, fail-closed public surfaces, and patient language rules so the model cannot invent a forming clinical baseline. Staging on Azure with Key Vault-held secrets.

FitGenius — Founding Technical Partner

May 2026 – Sep 2026

- Applied Gemini on Vertex to fitness: catalog-constrained coach, JSON plans, food estimates, and client/server context parity. Stripped GPS, health samples, and photos from model payloads. Hybrid: LLM features plus deterministic overload/pace/Fit Score engines.

Local AI — Product Engineer

2026

- Offline Windows desktop app (Tauri 2 + React + Rust): local GGUF via llama.cpp, chat, model library, documents + RAG, NSIS installer. UI never calls cloud inference APIs.

LaunchPage Studios — Founding Engineer · Oct 2025 – Present

Shipped TaxTacker, Alex Road Service, and Insightful Care as full products (AI is not the headline there). Earlier: Database Engineer Intern, City of Elizabeth (May–Sep 2024).

EDUCATION

Columbia University — B.S., Computer Engineering · Sep 2023 – Present

St. Lawrence University — B.A., Mathematics · Jul 2020 – May 2023 · **James Cook University** — Computer Engineering exchange · Jun–Nov 2022

SKILLS

AI product: Gemini, Vertex AI, Azure OpenAI, llama.cpp / GGUF, prompt packs, kill switches, grounding · not model training

Build: TypeScript, Swift, React, Expo, Fastify, Firebase/GCP, Azure, Rust/Tauri